

House Vemer

House Vemer

"STRENGTH TO THE KING"

Quick Facts

Status: Marquess/Marquis

Origin: Southern Aicruae

House Name Meaning: The Last Warrior

Founded: 8,265 BR

Founder: Ualvo Vemer I

Seat: Basar Tari, Southern Aicruae (shared with House Yurea)

Faction: Divine Faction

Spirit Animal: Sperent (Black Mamba)

Colors: TBD

Wealth: ~126,000 Rern

Military: Foot soldiers and trained assassins (numbers undetermined)

Religion: Leneyez

Theme Song: "The Beginning of the End" by Klergy x Valerie Broussard

Status By Era

Pre-Empire Era: Marquess rank, Divine Faction. House Vemer rises from the posthumous glory of Ualvo Vemer I and the forced marriage alliance of the Code of Rose. As Southern Aicruae's legitimate economy collapses, the house entangles itself with the UIB the Underground Illegal Business operating out of Basar Tari. They claim they're too weak to stop the criminal networks. In truth, they profit from them. By the time of the civil war, House Vemer is wealthy, connected, and deeply compromised.

Solis's Era: Survives the civil war by surrendering to Emperor Solis and claiming their support of the twins was solely due to the Code of Rose, the marriage obligation binding them to House Vika. No one believed them, but no one could prove otherwise. House Vika is ash. The Code of Rose is a dead alliance with a

dead house. House Vemer survives the civil war by surrendering to Solis and blaming their loyalty to the twins on a marriage obligation no one believes. But survival comes with scrutiny. The new empire is larger, more centralized, and less tolerant of lawless corners. Imperial administrators arrive in Southern Aicruae. Not many, and not with much enthusiasm, the south is still a wasteland no one wants, but enough to make the old arrangements uncomfortable.

The UIB doesn't disappear, but House Vemer begins creating distance. Quietly. Carefully. The bribes become less direct. The kickbacks route through more intermediaries. Publicly, the Vemers emphasize their legitimate authority as prison administrators and border wardens. It's not a reformation. It's repositioning. The empire is watching now, and the snake house knows when to shed its skin.

Crandona's Era: [TBD]

Minara's Era: Two and a half millennia changes everything even House Vemer. The rehabilitation took centuries. Imperial pressure forced the first steps: cutting obvious UIB ties, professionalizing the prison administration, cooperating with crown investigators just enough to avoid scrutiny. But somewhere along the way, survival strategy became genuine ambition. Generations of Vemers grew tired of being the house everyone whispered about. They produced capable leaders, married into respectable families, invested in infrastructure, and slowly painfully built a reputation that didn't reek of criminality. By Minara's Era, the UIB connection is ancient history. Scholars mention it in texts about Pre-Empire corruption. The current Vemers acknowledge it the way old families acknowledge embarrassing ancestors: briefly, carefully, and with emphasis on how far they've come. House Vemer is no longer the snake house running a criminal operation under a noble crest. They're the house that pulled itself out of the mud. The black mamba still coils on their banner. The motto still says "Strength to the king." But the two tongues have become one. Mostly.

Nicknames People Call Them During This Era

"Southern Vipers"

"The King's Snakes"

"The Victors of Little Hill"

"Vika's Leash" (after the Code of Rose, they're tied to House Vika through

marriage)

"Vika's Dogs" (implying they're subordinate to Vika through the marriage alliance)

Why They Matter

House Vemer is what happens when a family builds its legacy on one dead man's glory and then spends every generation after trying to hold onto something they never fully earned.

Ualvo Vemer I won the Battle of Little Hill and died for it. His son Hasken forced his way into a marriage with the most desirable woman in Aicruae, Aintana Vika, the Winter Rose, because he believed the son of a great hero deserved nothing less. That marriage, the Code of Rose, tied House Vemer to House Vika and gave them a legitimacy they couldn't manufacture on their own. But the alliance came at a cost. Hasken's obsession with Aintana poisoned the family for generations: a son who feared him, triplet granddaughters named as trophies, and a succession line that nearly collapsed because no one would marry into a house still haunted by a dead man's grip.

And beneath the surface, something darker. House Vemer shares control of Basar Tari with House Yurea, and both houses have disclosed ties to the UIB, the Underground Illegal Business, a criminal network dealing in assassination, smuggling, human trafficking, and every kind of trade the crown pretends doesn't exist. On the surface, House Vemer claims they're too weak to stop the UIB. The official line is that they tolerate it for the overall well-being of the territory. The truth is that Vemer members are secretly involved, and the bribes keep flowing. Their motto says "Strength to the king," but the question is which king, the one on the throne, or the one paying them under the table.

They're the house that looks legitimate if you don't look too hard. And most people don't.

Heraldry

Crest: Argent (silver/gray) field. In chief, a blue open eye with black outline. At center, a sable serpent coiled and striking, with purle underbelly, tongue extended, pierced by a purple bend sinister (diagonal bar running upper left to lower right). In base, a blue iris flower with golden stamens and green leaves.

Symbolism: The silver/gray field represents neutrality, survival, and adaptability. The open blue eye is the symbol of Vapaz, King of the Gods, representing divine authority, watchfulness, and legitimate power. It reinforces their motto: "Strength to the King." The open eye declares House Vemer's allegiance to the divine order and the throne (though whether they truly serve the king on the throne or the one paying under the table is another question). The coiled serpent represents their spirit animal, the Sperlent (black mamba), deadly precision, calculated strikes, and the willingness to eliminate threats before anyone realizes there was a problem. The purple bar cutting through the serpent symbolizes restraint, control, and a divided nature, the snake is dangerous, but it serves. The blue iris flower represents loyalty and a message, the iris is traditionally a flower of communication and hidden meanings, fitting for a house tied to information brokering and secrets. The blue ties it to their house colors.

Motto: "Strength to the King."

Power & Influence

Source of Power

Criminal connections, the UIB network, the Code of Rose marriage alliance, and the legacy of Ualvo Vemer I. House Vemer's power is not built on open military dominance or trade empires, it's built on proximity to dangerous people and the willingness to look the other way. Their seat in Basar Tari, the unofficial hub of the UIB, gives them access to assassination services, smuggling routes, information brokering, and illegal trade that most noble houses pretend not to use but quietly benefit from.

Internal Power Structure

Male advantage system. Women can inherit if no male heir is present, but only on the condition that she keeps the Vemer name and does not take her husband's surname. The family line, and the Vemer name is protected above all else.

Military Forces

Foot soldiers and trained assassins. Exact numbers are undetermined, but the assassin training aligns with the house's relationship to the UIB and its reputation

for being “dangerous and willing to take out anyone who gets in their way.”

Lands & Income

Seat: Basar Tari in Southern Aicruae, shared with House Yurea. Southern Aicruae is described as a “barren wasteland with nothing to offer” the legitimate economy is weak, and crime fills the vacuum. The region houses the largest prison in all of Aicruae, and the distance from the capital Lajazer means less crown oversight. Most guards and officials in Basar Tari have been silently corrupted.

Key industries: House Vemer’s wealth doesn’t come from the land. Southern Aicruae is a barren wasteland with a dead legitimate economy. Their 126,000 Rern comes from other sources.

Prison administration Basar Tari houses the largest prison in all of Aicruae. The crown pays for its operation. House Vemer administers it. What gets skimmed in the process is between the Vemers and their accountants.

Border tariffs Southern Aicruae borders Pireaynea, a country with a difficult relationship with Aicruae. Whatever trade passes through legitimate or otherwise House Vemer taxes. The tariffs are modest. The bribes to avoid the tariffs are better.

Assassin services House Vemer trains assassins. Officially, they’re for house defense. Unofficially, noble houses across Aicruae know who to contact when problems need to disappear quietly. The Vemers don’t advertise. They don’t need to.

Information brokering The UIB deals in secrets: blackmail material, noble indiscretions, political vulnerabilities. House Vemer takes a cut of what passes through their territory. Knowledge is cheaper than assassination and often more effective.

UIB kickbacks The real source of Vemer wealth. They tolerate the Underground Illegal Business the smuggling, the gambling, the trafficking, the trade in prohibited goods and the UIB pays them for the privilege. It’s not legitimate income. It’s not even hidden income. It’s just income no one can prove.

Smuggling facilitation Stone Powder from Equateiy. Joyless Death poison produced by House Vika and sold through back channels. Luxury goods from

Pireaynea avoiding crown tariffs. It all moves through Southern Aicruae, and House Vemer makes sure it moves smoothly.

Alliances & Rivalries

Allied Houses

House Vika (Code of Rose): Marriage alliance through Aintana Vika and Hasken Vemer. This was not a love match, Aintana rejected Hasken, and he forced the marriage through a royal order. The Code of Rose became the defining alliance of House Vemer's history, tying them to the most powerful military house in Aicruae. When the civil war came, House Vemer used the Code of Rose as their excuse for backing the twins and later as their excuse for surrendering to Solis.

House Kulio (Marriage): Fasi Vemer married Jando Kulio, creating the Kulio-Vemer alliance.

House Yurea (Territorial): Both houses share control of Basar Tari and both have disclosed ties to the UIB. The relationship is less a formal alliance and more a mutual understanding: they tolerate each other because the alternative is exposing what they both have to hide.

Rival Houses

House Arvento The Arventos created the Council of the Forsaken to investigate violent crimes. They are fiercely loyal to the crown, incorruptible, and everything House Vemer pretends to be. The Arventos know about the UIB. They know Vemer tolerates it. They know the "too weak to stop it" excuse is a lie. But Southern Aicruae is outside their jurisdiction, and the crown has written it off. So the Arventos watch, and wait, and remember. If House Vemer ever gives them an opening, they'll take it.

House Caraen Capital protectors, Council of the Forsaken members, and bearers of a name that means "Gift from the Gods." Caraen sees Vemer as everything wrong with the Divine Faction nobles who claim divine right while running a criminal enterprise in the kingdom's most lawless region. The Caraens don't hide their contempt. They just can't prove anything yet.

House Aedria The third leg of the Council of the Forsaken. House Aedria is the "IT family" beloved, respected, the house everyone wants to be. They represent what

nobility is supposed to look like. House Vemer represents what it actually looks like when no one's watching. The two have nothing in common except mutual awareness that they exist on opposite ends of the same system.

House Yurea Co-conspirators make the worst rivals. House Yurea shares Basar Tari with House Vemer, and both houses have disclosed ties to the UIB. On the surface, it's a mutual understanding they tolerate each other because exposing one means exposing both. Underneath, it's a cold war. They know too much about each other. Every deal, every bribe, every body. If one house ever decides the other is more liability than ally, Southern Aicruae will get very bloody very fast.

The Common People Faction House Leva, House Dajanyi, House Yurea all of them look at House Vemer and see hypocrisy in noble clothing. Vemer claims Divine Faction membership, insisting on the divine right of nobility, while running a criminal operation that exploits the poorest people in the kingdom. The Common People Faction doesn't have the power to bring Vemer down. But they have the resentment, and resentment has a long memory.

Shared Territory

House Yurea: Both houses occupy Basar Tari in Southern Aicruae and are equally implicated in the UIB criminal network.

House Culture

Religion

Leneyez.

Traditions

The Shedding: When a Vemer heir takes control of the house, they must publicly "shed" the previous leadership. The form this takes is up to the heir: some burn a piece of their predecessor's clothing, others destroy a personal possession, others change their manner of dress entirely. The only rule is that something must visibly go. The ritual acknowledges that the snake has grown new skin the old is discarded, the new is what matters now. Sentimental heirs have been known to burn a single glove. Ruthless ones have burned livestock belong to the previous

leader. What you choose to shed says something about what kind of leader you'll be.

Rose and Fang Once a year, House Vemer commemorates the Code of Rose their marriage alliance with House Vika. Red roses are placed on the family altar alongside the Black Mamba imagery: petals and scales, beauty and venom. The tradition began when both houses were powerful. It continued after Solis burned House Vika to the ground. Vemers still lay the roses. Whether it's loyalty, guilt, or just habit, no living Vemer will say.

Values

House Vemer understands the difference between what you say and what you do.

Loyalty on paper Their motto is "Strength to the king." Their founder died winning a battle for the crown. Every Vemer swears service to the throne. It sounds noble. It's meant to. But "strength to the king" doesn't specify which king, and Vemers have always been flexible about where their strength gets pointed. They sided with the twins during the civil war, then surrendered to Solis and claimed the Code of Rose made them do it. The motto isn't a promise. It's a shield.

Ruthlessness as clarity The Black Mamba is their symbol for a reason. Vemers don't pretend to be good. They pretend to be loyal, which is different. Behind closed doors, they're honest about what they are: dangerous, calculating, willing to take out anyone in their way. The UIB operates in their territory because Vemers allow it. The crown looks the other way because Vemers are useful.

Survival above all Their founder was a bread maker's son. They rule a barren wasteland the crown has written off. They've never had the luxury of principles. Morality is for houses with options. Vemers do what they must forge alliances, tolerate crime, force marriages, switch sides and they sleep fine.

Usefulness over affection Vemers don't expect to be loved. They expect to be needed. As long as they're strong enough to be useful to whoever holds power, they'll survive. That's the only currency that matters.

Reputation

Best described as "sort of influential due to their rank and social position." House Vemer sits in a strange middle ground, they hold noble status and Divine Faction membership, but their seat is in the most lawless region of Aicruae. The other

houses know about the UIB ties. The crown knows. Everyone knows. But Southern Aicruae has been essentially written off, and as long as House Vemer keeps things quiet and keeps saying "strength to the king," no one pushes too hard.

Their spirit animal tells you everything. The black mamba doesn't roar or charge, it's fast, it calculates, and it kills with deadly accuracy. House Vemer doesn't fight wars. They take out problems before anyone realizes there was a problem to begin with.

Common Sayings About/from House Vemer

"Loyalty feeds no one." Said only among family, never at court. A reminder that pretty words don't keep the house alive. Vemers are loyal when it's useful and practical when it's not. Anyone who confuses the performance for the priority won't last long.

"Two tongues, one throat." The closest thing Vemers have to a proverb. What you say in public and what you say in private both come from the same mouth. Neither is a lie. They're just different truths for different rooms.

"Strong for the king. Stronger for ourselves." A private twist on their official motto. Children learn "Strength to the king" first. They learn this version later, when they're old enough to understand the difference.

"The south makes its own law." Part defiance, part resignation. The crown has written off Southern Aicruae as a barren wasteland, so the people who live there Vemers included operate by their own rules. Said with varying degrees of pride depending on who's speaking.

History

Founding (8,265 BR)

Ualvo Vemer I was the son of a bread maker, no noble blood, no military dynasty, no birthright. He earned everything on the battlefield. His victory at the Battle of Little Hill in 8,264 BR was significant enough to earn him posthumous nobility, because Ualvo didn't survive to see the title. He died following the battle, and the noble status was granted posthumously. House Vemer was founded in 8,265 BR, a house born from a dead hero's glory. The name Vemer means "The Last Warrior."

Rise to Power

House Vemer began with a corpse and a debt.

Ualvo Vemer I was a bread maker's son with no name, no title, and no future until he won the Battle of Little Hill and died doing it. The crown granted him nobility posthumously, which meant his son Hasken inherited a title but no infrastructure, no allies, and a seat in Southern Aicruae, the kingdom's wasteland.

Hasken built what his father couldn't. When Aintana Vika daughter of the most powerful military house in Aicruae rejected his marriage proposal, he petitioned the crown for a royal order forcing her hand. He got it. The Code of Rose bound House Vemer to House Vika, and suddenly the bread maker's grandson had the backing of dukes. The Vemers leveraged that alliance ruthlessly, climbing from new-money nobodies to Marquess rank within two generations.

Their other asset was their territory. Southern Aicruae offered nothing legitimate barren land, a prison colony, desperate people. But desperate people create opportunities. The UIB grew in Basar Tari's shadows, and the Vemers grew alongside it. They collected bribes, looked the other way, and built wealth where no wealth should exist. By the time of the civil war, House Vemer was entrenched: not respected, but too useful to remove.

Major Achievements

Battle of Little Hill (8,264 BR) The victory that created the house. Ualvo Vemer died for it; his descendants have lived off it ever since.

Code of Rose Hasken's forced marriage to Aintana Vika secured an alliance with the most powerful house in Eastern Aicruae. The Vemers punched above their weight for generations because of it.

Surviving the civil war They backed the losing side and still kept their seat. The excuse was flimsy, but they're still here.

House Kulio marriage alliance Fasi Vemer married Jando Kulio, connecting Vemer to another divine-faction house and expanding their network westward.

Major Disgraces

The Forced Marriage Hasken Vemer couldn't accept rejection. He used a royal order to drag Aintana Vika to the altar. The Code of Rose is an alliance built on

coercion, and everyone knows it.

UIB Complicity House Vemer publicly claims they're too weak to stop the criminal networks in their territory. Privately, they profit from them. The crown pretends not to notice. Other houses don't pretend.

Civil War Cowardice They sided with Iris and Orcus, then surrendered and blamed the Code of Rose. No one believed them. The reputation for convenient loyalties has never faded.

Jando Kulio's Murder Fasi Vemer's husband was found stabbed outside a brothel with roses stuffed in his eyes — likely killed by a scorned lover. The marriage that was supposed to strengthen both houses ended in scandal. What Fasi did after remains a subject of whispers.

The UIB Connection

House Vemer and House Yurea are the two noble houses with disclosed ties to the Underground Illegal Business. Members of both houses are secretly involved in the UIB's operations, which include assassination, kidnapping and ransom, information brokering, illegal gambling, prostitution networks, human trafficking, and the smuggling of prohibited goods including Joyless Death poison and Stone Powder imported from Equateiy.

The official reasoning is that they're "too weak to stop the UIB activities and must pretend it doesn't exist for the overall well-being of the territory." In practice, both houses tolerate UIB activity in exchange for bribes. The UIB has no single leader it's a loose network of multiple competing groups with territorial agreements, and local bosses control specific towns and trade routes. Basar Tari is the unofficial hub, and most of its guards and officials have been silently corrupted.

The UIB persists because Southern Aicruae is a barren wasteland with a dead economy. The largest prison in Aicruae draws desperate people families of prisoners, released convicts with no options and the distance from the capital means less crown oversight. Crime runs more rampant in Southern Aicruae than anywhere else, and people are leaving for Western Aicruae. The crown has essentially written off the south.

Role in the Civil War

House Vemer sided with the twins (Iris and Orcus) during the Aicruan Civil War, tied by the Code of Rose to House Vika. After the war ended and Solis won, House Vemer surrendered and claimed their involvement was purely due to the marriage obligation. No one believed them, but the excuse was just thin enough to survive on. House Vemer endured where House Vika was eradicated.

Notable Members

Listed chronologically, from the house's origins to the generations that followed.

Ualvo Vemer I (8,298 BR – 8,264 BR)

"The Great Hero" | Founder of House Vemer — Name meaning: Dark

The son of a bread maker who became a war hero. Ualvo won the Battle of Little Hill in 8,264 BR, a victory significant enough to earn him nobility but he didn't live to receive the title. He died following the battle, and the noble status was granted posthumously. Everything House Vemer has, everything they claim to be, traces back to this one man who bled out before he could see what his name became.

"War can change a man's fate. It could be for the better or for the worst but that man's life will have been changed."

Hasken Vemer (8,274 BR – 8,206 BR)

Son of Ualvo | Architect of the Code of Rose — Name meaning: Sweet and True

Hasken believed he deserved the best and to him, the best was Aintana Vika, the Winter Rose, the most beautiful woman in the Aicruaen nobility. When she rejected him, he didn't accept it. He obtained a royal order forcing her to marry him, because in his mind, the son of the great hero Ualvo Vemer deserved nothing less than the jewel of House Vika.

That forced marriage became the Code of Rose the alliance that would define House Vemer for centuries. Aintana gave him three sons, but their marriage was a one-sided love affair. She could never love him as much as he loved her. And Hasken's obsession didn't end with his wife. When his son Rashar produced triplet daughters who resembled Aintana, Hasken demanded all three be named after her, threatening to disinherit Rashar if he refused. His intimidation was so

thorough that even after his death at age 68 from a “mysterious illness” suitors were still too afraid to approach his granddaughters.

Hasken got what he wanted: the most beautiful woman in Aicruae, an alliance with the most powerful military house, and a legacy stamped with Aintana’s face. What he couldn’t get was her love, her willingness, or a family that didn’t fear him.

Rashar Vemer (8,254 BR – 8,178 BR)

Son of Hasken — Name meaning: Wrath of the Sun

One of Hasken’s three sons, and the one his father hated most because Rashar looked like Hasken rather than Aintana. That was the crime. Looking like his own father. Rashar was terrified of Hasken his entire life, and that fear bled into how he treated his own daughters. When triplet girls were born who looked like their grandmother Aintana, Rashar wanted to cut their hair — their hair was the same color as Aintana’s, and he couldn’t stand the reminder. His wife stopped him, arguing that no man would marry daughters with shorn hair. So the hair stayed, and the girls grew up looking exactly like the woman their grandfather was obsessed with.

The Triplets and the Code of Rose

The ghost of Aintana Vika haunted House Vemer for three generations and nowhere more visibly than in the faces of three girls who never asked to carry her name. The Code of Rose was supposed to be a marriage alliance. What it actually became was a cage for Aintana, who never loved the man who forced her into it; for Rashar, who could never be enough for his father; for three girls named after a grandmother they never chose to resemble; and for House Vemer itself, which built its identity around a woman who wanted nothing to do with them.

Anatina Vemer I (8,225 BR – 8,149 BR)

Name meaning: The Rose’s Daughter

The eldest of the triplets. Named after her grandmother Aintana at Hasken’s demand the same grandfather who terrorized her father and forced her grandmother into marriage. Anatina I never married. Hasken’s intimidation of suitors was so complete that even after his death, no man would come near her.

She spent her life resenting her father Rashar and her grandmother Aintana for not stopping Hasken when they had the chance. Died at 76, unmarried.

Anatina Vemer II (8,225 BR – 8,132 BR)

Name meaning: The Rose's Daughter

The only triplet sister to marry. Mother of Tena Vemer. Widowed fairly early on into her marriage. Of the three sisters, she was the one who carried the Vemer line forward without her marriage and her daughter Tena, the house might have collapsed entirely. Died at 93.

Anatina Vemer III (8,225 BR – 8,127 BR)

Name meaning: The Rose's Daughter

The youngest triplet. Like her sister Anatina I, she never married. Died at 98, the longest-lived of the three.

Tena Vemer (8,159 BR – 8,087 BR)

Name meaning: 100 Years of Beauty

Daughter of Anatina Vemer II and the heir who saved House Vemer from extinction. Tena was described as "the light and joy of her mother's life," raised in extreme shelter by her widowed mother. She was "the long-awaited heir who cemented Rashar's line and created a continuation that helped maintain the Code of Rose." Her birth signified a new age for House Vemer proof that the line would survive, that the alliance with House Vika still held, and that Hasken's obsession hadn't destroyed the family entirely. It had only warped it.

Fasi Vemer (7,652 BR - 7,595 BR)

Name meaning: [Silent Bloom]

The marriage to Jando Kulio was political an alliance between House Vemer and House Kulio, snake and owl, southern pragmatism and western divine blood. Jando was handsome, charming, and incapable of fidelity. He led noble girls on before the marriage. He continued after. Fasi said nothing. She attended court functions at his side, smiled when expected, and watched her husband collect lovers the way other men collected horses.

Then Jando was found stabbed to death outside a brothel. Two roses had been stuffed into his eyes.

The roses were the detail everyone remembered. Roses —the symbol of the Code of Rose, House Vemer's defining alliance. A Vemer signature, or someone wanted it to look that way. Suspicion fell on Fasi immediately. A patient wife who finally stopped being patient. A Vemer who remembered that her house dealt in assassins. Nothing was ever proven. Fasi expressed appropriate grief, wore appropriate mourning, and returned to Southern Aicruae after a respectable interval.

She never remarried. Whether that was choice or circumstance is a matter of interpretation. Suitors may have been cautious about courting an alleged husband-killer. Or Fasi may simply have had no interest in repeating the experience. She lived another twenty-six years, dying at fifty-seven in the family seat at Basar Tari.

House Kulio never formally accused her. The alliance technically survived. But after Fasi, no Kulio married a Vemer again.

Married Jando Kulio, creating the Kulio-Vemer alliance. Beyond the marriage, little is recorded about Fasi but the alliance with House Kulio gave House Vemer a second marriage connection to a major noble house, diversifying their political ties beyond the Code of Rose.

Strengths & Weaknesses

Known For

The Code of Rose alliance with House Vika, UIB connections, trained assassins, survival instincts (surrendering to Solis after the civil war rather than dying for a lost cause), and a willingness to operate in the grey areas that other noble houses pretend don't exist.

What They Lack

Legitimate power Their entire foundation rests on one dead hero, a forced marriage, and criminal income. Strip away the UIB and House Vemer is a Marquess family ruling a wasteland with no army, no trade, and no allies.

Military strength They have foot soldiers and assassins, but no army. In an open war, they lose. Their survival depends on never fighting one.

Respect The other Divine Faction houses tolerate Vemer because the alternative is acknowledging what everyone already knows. No one admires them. No one wants to be them. They're useful, and that's the ceiling.

A clean reputation The UIB whispers follow them everywhere. The civil war surrender follows them everywhere. The Code of Rose a marriage built on coercion follows them everywhere. House Vemer can't escape its own history.

Their strongest ally House Vika is gone. Solis burned them to the ground. The Code of Rose is a dead alliance now, and Vemer has nothing to replace it. Their marriage connection to House Kulio is weaker, and Kulio has its own problems.

Vulnerabilities

The UIB is a leash, not a partnership House Vemer depends on criminal income. That means they depend on criminals. If the UIB ever decides Vemer is more useful as a scapegoat than a partner, there's nothing protecting them.

House Yurea knows everything Co-conspirators make the worst enemies. House Yurea shares Basar Tari and shares the UIB connection. If the relationship sours, Yurea can bury Vemer and Vemer can bury Yurea. Mutually assured destruction is not stability.

The Council of the Forsaken is watching Arvento, Caraen, and Aedria created a body specifically to investigate violent crimes. They know about Vemer. They're waiting for proof, or for Vemer to slip. One mistake, one witness, one disgruntled UIB boss looking to trade information for immunity and the Council has what it needs.

Southern Aicruae is collapsing People are leaving for Western Aicruae. The legitimate economy is dead. The only thing keeping the region functional is crime, and crime doesn't build infrastructure. Eventually, there won't be enough people left to exploit.

Their survival depends on a lie They told Solis the Code of Rose made them fight for the twins. No one believed it. But no one could disprove it either, and Solis had bigger problems than one snake house in the south. If anyone ever finds evidence that Vemer's support for the twins was genuine letters, witnesses, anything their

survival story falls apart. Their strongest claim from then on was the Code of Rose made them have to listen to the Twins, and everything they did was because they had no choice but to and that it was an order.

Role in Narrative

Book Appearances: [TBD]

Plot Significance: House Vemer's ties to the UIB and their Code of Rose obligation to House Vika position them at the intersection of organized crime and noble politics. Their survival of the civil war when their strongest ally, House Vika, was eradicated, raises questions about what deals they made and what they were willing to sacrifice to endure.

Key Members in Story: [TBD]

Cross-References

House Vika, House Kulio, House Yurea, House Patton, Ualvo Vemer I, Hasken Vemer, Aintana Vika (The Winter Rose), Rashar Vemer, Anatina Vemer I, Anatina Vemer II, Anatina Vemer III, Tena Vemer, Fasi Vemer, Jando Kulio, Emperor Solis Elias Patton, Basar Tari, Southern Aicruae, Battle of Little Hill, Code of Rose (House Vika Alliance), The UIB (Underground Illegal Business), Joyless Death (Poison), Stone Powder (Drug), Leneyez (Religion), Divine Faction, Aicruan Civil War, Lajazer, Western Aicruae

Keywords

House Vemer, Vemer, The Last Warrior, Strength to the King, Southern Aicruae, Basar Tari, Divine Faction, Black Mamba, Sperent, Khaki, Blue, Silver-Gray, Leneyez, The Beginning of the End, Klergy, Valerie Broussard, UIB, Underground Illegal Business, Ualvo Vemer I, The Great Hero, Hasken Vemer, Aintana Vika, Winter Rose, Code of Rose, Rashar Vemer, Anatina Vemer I, Anatina Vemer II, Anatina Vemer III, Tena Vemer, Fasi Vemer, Jando Kulio, House Vika, House Kulio, House Yurea, Battle of Little Hill, Aicruan Civil War, Trained Assassins, Rern, Triplets, Rose's Daughter, Male Advantage System, Bread Maker, Posthumous Nobility